ACTIVITY PACK

Activity 4: Readme

Activity 4 - Install Tools and Skills to Do Better

Course	AI Agent Security
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Tertiary Infotech Pte Ltd | UEN 201200696W

Readme

Activity 4 - Install Tools and Skills to Do Better

Purpose: Add two ready-made **skills** to the AI agent, then run the **same tasks before and after** to see how much a skill improves the result.

What you need

- The **Hermes** agent (trainer will share the link/login)
- Hermes documentation for adding tools/skills: hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs
- The results you saved from **Activity 2** (Excel) and **Activity 3** (PowerPoint)
- The guides in this folder: `WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md` (the two real skills and how to install them) and `PROMPTS.md` (the 10-slide prompt you run twice)

Evidence status: SIM - all data is fictional. Continue using the same fictional Sunset Bay Resort data. The two skills themselves are real, publicly available skills.

What is a "skill" (in plain terms)?

A **skill** is a small ready-made ability you switch on for the agent - like adding an app to a phone. You do **not** write code. Skills come from public skill libraries (see `WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md`); you install one and the agent handles that kind of task better.

Steps

1. **Before installing anything**, run the **10-slide prompt** in `PROMPTS.md`. Save the result as **Deck A (no skill)**.
2. Still before installing, re-run your **Activity 2 task** (top channels by ROI, or the exec summary) with the same GOOD prompt. Save the answer as **Answer A**.
3. Install the two skills following `WHAT-TO-INSTALL.md`: the `xlsx` spreadsheet skill and the `pptx` slides skill (both from Anthropic's public skills repo, github.com/anthropics/skills).
4. Re-run the **same 10-slide prompt, word for word** -> save as **Deck B (with skill)**. Fill in the comparison table in `PROMPTS.md`.
5. Re-run the **same Activity 2 prompt** -> save as **Answer B** and compare with Answer A.
6. Note, for each skill, **one clear improvement** and **one thing that stayed the same or got worse**.

What you produce

- **Deck A vs Deck B:** the same 10-slide prompt without and with the `pptx` skill, plus the filled-in comparison table
- **Answer A vs Answer B:** the same Excel prompt without and with the `xlsx` skill
- A short verdict: was each skill worth turning on? Why?

Reflect (Data Privacy / Job Impact / Ethical Concerns / Cyber Security)

- **Data Privacy:** A new skill may read your uploaded file. Do you know what it can access before you switch it on?
- **Job Impact:** With skills doing more, which parts of the job become "checking the agent" rather than "doing the work"?
- **Ethical Concerns:** A skill that formats nicely can also make a wrong answer look convincing. How do you still verify?
- **Cyber Security:** Who in a real workplace should approve a new skill before staff install it?

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